

# Word family: \*\*pay / paid / paying / payment / payable / payer\*\*

\*\*Base word:\*\* pay

\*\*Past tense:\*\* paid

\*\*Past participle:\*\* paid

\*\*ing form:\*\* paying

\*\*Related forms:\*\* payment, payable, payer

\*\*Part of speech:\*\* verb ( 動詞 ) / noun ( 名詞 ) / adjective-related forms ( 相關形容詞 )

Your sentence:

> “Sometimes it is simply someone who \*\*pays deep attention\*\*, tells stories well, and makes other people see the world with new eyes.”

## Meaning in this passage

Here, \*\*pay\*\* appears in the expression \*\*pay attention\*\*.

It does **not** mean giving money. **Pay attention** means to **deliberately direct your mind, awareness, or concentration towards someone or something**.

In this passage, Mr. Wong pays close attention to the small details of the world around him.

**繁體中文：** **有意識地把注意力、心思和觀察集中在某人或某件事情上，認真留意其細節**

**中文翻譯：**

> “...someone who **pays deep attention**...”

「.....一個願意**深入留意 / 非常仔細觀察**周圍事物的人.....」

Here:

**pay attention = 把注意力集中在某人或某件事情上；認真留意**

Because **pay attention** is the construction actually used in the passage, it deserves explicit treatment even though the SOP normally avoids expanding into unrelated phrasal constructions.

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# 1. **pay + money/amount/person ( 款項 / 人物 ) — 支付；付錢**

This is the basic monetary meaning.

**Meaning:** To give money to someone in exchange for goods, services, work, or to settle an amount owed.

#### ### Practice 1

> “I **paid** fifty dollars for the book.”

「我為這本書**付了五十元**。」

#### ### Practice 2

> “Have you **paid** the driver?”

「你已經**付錢給司機**了嗎？」

**pay** = 把金錢交給某人，以購買商品、服務，或償還應付的款項

Common patterns:

- \* pay someone
- \* pay a bill
- \* pay a fee
- \* pay rent
- \* pay tax
- \* pay for something
- \* pay someone for something

These are one broad **give money** sense.

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# 2. **pay** + employee/person ( 薪酬 ) — 支付薪金；給.....報酬

**Pay** can specifically mean giving someone money for work they have done.

#### ### Practice 3

> “The company **pays** its staff at the end of each month.”

「公司每月底向員工**發薪 / 支付薪金**。」

#### ### Practice 4

> “They **paid** her well for the work.”

「他們為那份工作給她**很好的報酬**。」

**pay someone for work** = 因某人提供勞動或服務而向其支付薪金、工資或報酬

Semantically, this is still part of the basic **\*\*give money\*\*** meaning.

For database counting, I would **\*\*merge it with Meaning 1\*\*** rather than create a separate core sense merely because the recipient is an employee.

That follows the Golden Manual's rule that changing the object or context does not automatically create a new lexical meaning.

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# 3. **\*\*pay = provide financial return/profit ( 投資 / 工作 ) — 有回報 ; 賺錢 ; 划算\*\***

Here, **\*\*pay\*\*** becomes intransitive.

**\*\*Meaning:\*\*** To produce enough money, profit, or financial benefit to make something worthwhile.

### Practice 5

> “It **\*\*pays\*\*** to compare prices before buying.”

「購買之前比較價錢是**\*\*有好處 / 划算的\*\***。」

### Practice 6

> “The investment eventually **\*\*paid\*\*** very well.”

「這項投資最終帶來了很好的**\*\*財務回報\*\***。」

**\*\*pay = 帶來金錢、盈利或足以令某件事情值得進行的實際回報\*\***

This is different from:

> **\*\*I pay money\*\***

because here the subject itself:

> **\*\*produces a return\*\***

rather than gives money to someone.

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# 4. **\*\*it pays to + verb ( 行動 / 選擇 ) — 值得 ; 有好處\*\***

A very common figurative extension is:

> **it pays to do something**

Here, the benefit does not have to be financial.

#### ### Practice 7

> “It **pays to** prepare carefully before an interview.”

「面試前仔細準備是**有好處 / 值得的**。」

#### ### Practice 8

> “It **pays to** listen before making a decision.”

「作決定之前先聽清楚別人的意見是**有益 / 值得的**。」

**it pays to do something** = 做某件事情通常會帶來實際好處，因此值得這樣做

For core counting, I would connect this to Meaning 3:

> **produce a worthwhile return**

The “return” has simply become broader than money.

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# 5. **pay attention to + person/thing** ( 注意力 ) — 注意；留意

This is the meaning used in your passage.

**Meaning:** To deliberately concentrate your attention, awareness, or thought on something.

#### ### Practice 9 — Original

> “Sometimes it is simply someone who **pays deep attention**...”

「有時候，那只是一個願意**深入留意 / 非常仔細觀察**世界的人.....」

#### ### Practice 10

> “Please **pay attention to** the instructions.”

「請**留意 / 仔細聽清楚**指示。」

#### ### Practice 11

> “She **\*\*pays close attention to\*\*** small changes in people’s behaviour.”

「她會**\*\*仔細留意\*\***別人行為上的細微變化。」

**\*\*pay attention to something** = 主動把注意力集中在某件事情上，認真觀察、聆聽或思考**\*\***

Common:

- \* pay attention
- \* pay close attention
- \* pay careful attention
- \* pay particular attention

Your passage uses:

> **\*\*pay deep attention\*\***

which emphasizes sustained, thoughtful observation.

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# 6. **\*\*pay + respect/tribute/compliment ( 尊重 / 敬意 ) — 表達；致以\*\***

In several established collocations, **\*\*pay\*\*** means to give or express something abstract rather than money.

#### Practice 12

> “Thousands of people came to **\*\*pay their respects\*\***.”

「數以千計的人前來**\*\*致意 / 表達敬意\*\***。」

#### Practice 13

> “The film **\*\*pays tribute to\*\*** the city's early photographers.”

「這部電影向這座城市早期的攝影師**\*\*致敬\*\***。」

**\*\*pay + respect/tribute/etc.** = 向某人或某事物正式表達敬意、尊重或認可**\*\***

Common examples:

- \* pay respect
- \* pay tribute
- \* pay a compliment

\* pay homage

These share the broader semantic idea:

> \*\*give something owed or appropriate\*\*

but the “thing given” is symbolic rather than monetary.

I would keep this separate for learners because translating it as 「付」 would be misleading.

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# 7. \*\*pay + price/penalty/cost ( 代價 / 懲罰 ) — 付出代價 ; 承受後果\*\*

Here, \*\*pay\*\* figuratively means suffering or giving up something as the consequence of an action.

### Practice 14

> “He \*\*paid a heavy price\*\* for the mistake.”

「他為這個錯誤\*\*付出了沉重代價\*\*。」

### Practice 15

> “Eventually, the company \*\*paid the price\*\* for ignoring the problem.”

「公司最終因忽視問題而\*\*付出了代價 / 承受了後果\*\*。」

\*\*pay a price/penalty = 因某個行為、決定或錯誤而失去某些東西或承受不利後果\*\*

This is figurative but very common.

The “payment” here may be:

- \* money,
- \* reputation,
- \* health,
- \* time,
- \* opportunity,
- \* another negative consequence.

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# 8. \*\*pay + visit/call ( 正式固定搭配 ) — 拜訪 ; 致電\*\*

A few established constructions use \*\*pay\*\* in the sense of \*\*make/give\*\* an action.

#### ### Practice 16

> “We \*\*paid a visit\*\* to the museum.”

「我們\*\*參觀 / 拜訪了\*\*那間博物館。」

#### ### Practice 17

> “I decided to \*\*pay him a visit\*\*.”

「我決定去\*\*拜訪他\*\*。」

**\*\*pay a visit = 前往某個地方或見某人作一次拜訪\*\***

This is a fixed collocation rather than a productive general meaning of **\*\*pay\*\***.

Under the SOP, I would include it as a useful fixed expression, not inflate the core polysemy count.

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# Noun meaning: **\*\*pay = money earned from work ( 薪酬 ) — 工資 ; 薪金 ; 報酬\*\***

As a noun, **\*\*pay\*\*** means the money someone receives for doing a job.

#### ### Practice 18

> “The job offers good **\*\*pay\*\*** and flexible hours.”

「這份工作提供不錯的**\*\*薪酬\*\***和彈性工時。」

#### ### Practice 19

> “Workers are asking for higher **\*\*pay\*\***.”

「工人要求更高的**\*\*薪金 / 工資\*\***。」

**\*\*pay = 因工作或提供服務而收到的薪金、工資或報酬\*\***

This is a genuine noun meaning and should be included separately from the verb “give money.”

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# Related form: **\*\*payment\*\***

**\*\*Payment\*\*** means money that is paid, or the act of paying.

#### ### Practice 20

> “Your **payment** is due tomorrow.”

「你的**款項 / 付款**明天到期。」

#### ### Practice 21

> “The shop accepts card **payments**.”

「這間商店接受信用卡**付款**。」

**payment** = 支付的金錢，或支付金錢這個行為

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# Related form: **payable**

**Payable** commonly means money that must be paid, especially by a particular date or to a particular person.

#### ### Practice 22

> “The fee is **payable** in advance.”

「費用需要**預先支付**。」

#### ### Practice 23

> “The full amount is **payable** by Friday.”

「全部款項須於星期五前**支付**。」

**payable** = 按規定、合約或期限應該支付的

It can also mean:

> capable of being paid

but the **amount due** sense is the most practically useful.

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# Related form: **payer**

A **payer** is a person or organization that makes a payment.

#### ### Practice 24

> “The **payer** is responsible for the bank charges.”

「**付款人**需要負責銀行費用。」

#### ### Practice 25

> “Tax **payors** fund many public services.”

「**納稅人**的稅款支持很多公共服務。」

**payer** = 負責支付款項、費用或稅項的人 / 機構

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# Important distinction: **pay** vs **spend**

#### ### **pay**

focuses on **giving money to settle a charge or obtain something**.

> “I paid \$20 for the book.”

#### ### **spend**

focuses on **using money, time, or another resource**.

> “I spent \$20 on the book.”

Same purchase, different perspective:

**pay** = 付款行為

**spend** = 使用了多少資源

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# Important distinction: **pay** vs **cost**

#### ### **pay**

the buyer/person gives money:

> “I paid \$100.”

### \*\*cost\*\*

the product/service has a price:

> “It cost \$100.”

So:

> \*\*person pays\*\*

> \*\*thing costs\*\*

This is a major learner distinction.

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# Important distinction: \*\*pay attention vs give attention\*\*

Both are possible, but:

### \*\*pay attention\*\*

is the ordinary fixed expression for concentrating.

> “Pay attention to what she says.”

### \*\*give attention to\*\*

is possible but often more formal and may emphasize devoting consideration or resources.

Your passage therefore uses the very natural:

> \*\*pay attention\*\*

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# Important distinction: \*\*pay attention vs notice\*\*

### \*\*pay attention\*\*

is deliberate:

> actively concentrate on something.

### \*\*notice\*\*

means become aware of something.

> “I was paying attention to the street and noticed an unusual sign.”

You can:

**\*\*pay attention but notice nothing unusual\*\***

or:

**\*\*notice something without deliberately paying attention beforehand\*\***

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# Important distinction: **\*\*pay attention vs focus\*\***

### **\*\*pay attention to something\*\***

= deliberately notice/listen/watch carefully

### **\*\*focus on something\*\***

= direct and maintain concentration more narrowly on it

They overlap strongly, but **\*\*focus\*\*** often suggests stronger sustained concentration.

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# Important distinction: **\*\*pay vs repay\*\***

### **\*\*pay\*\***

= give money that is due, or pay for goods/services

### **\*\*repay\*\***

= return money previously borrowed, or figuratively return a favour/kindness

> “I paid the restaurant.”

> “I repaid the money I borrowed.”

Not interchangeable.

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## # Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

\* \*\*pay\*\*  
\* \*\*paid\*\*  
\* \*\*paying\*\*  
\* \*\*payment\*\*  
\* \*\*payable\*\*  
\* \*\*payer\*\*

Especially useful constructions include:

\* pay money  
\* pay someone  
\* pay for something  
\* pay attention  
\* pay respect  
\* pay tribute  
\* pay the price  
\* pay a visit  
\* it pays to...  
\* pay — noun = salary/wages

The Golden Manual requires useful grammatical patterns, compounds, and fixed expressions to be checked, but also requires semantic merging where the same broad concept explains several contexts.

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## # Master comparison

| Form / sense                 | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| -----                        | -----                                 |
| **pay — give money**         | 把金錢交給某人，以購買商品 / 服務、償還款項或履行付款責任        |
|                              |                                       |
| **pay — produce a return**   | 某項工作、投資或行動帶來金錢或其他足以令它值得進行的回報          |
|                              |                                       |
| **pay attention**            | 主動把注意力集中在某人或某件事情上，仔細觀察、聆聽或思考          |
| **pay respect/tribute/etc.** | 向某人或某事物正式表達敬意、尊重、認可或其他象徵性表示           |
|                              |                                       |
| **pay a price/penalty**      | 因某個行為、決定或錯誤而失去某些東西或承受不利後果             |
| **pay — noun**               | 因工作或提供服務而收到的薪金、工資或報酬                  |
| **payment**                  | 支付的款項，或支付金錢這個行為                       |

|             |                   |  |
|-------------|-------------------|--|
| **payable** | 按規定、合約或期限應該支付的    |  |
| **payer**   | 負責支付款項、費用或稅項的人或機構 |  |

# For your original sentence

> "...someone who \*\*pays deep attention\*\*, tells stories well..."

The exact meaning is:

**\*\*pay attention = 有意識地把注意力集中在某件事情上，認真留意和觀察\*\***

More specifically:

**\*\*pay deep attention = 不只是隨便看看，而是持續、仔細並深入地留意周圍的人、事情和細節\*\***

So:

> **\*\*someone who pays deep attention\*\***

= **\*\*一個非常仔細、深入地留意世界和周圍細節的人\*\***

For your database, I would count **\*\*6 genuinely useful core polysemy/polyfunctionality meanings\*\*** for **\*\*pay\*\***:

1. **\*\*give money / settle an amount\*\***
2. **\*\*produce a worthwhile financial or practical return\*\***
3. **\*\*pay attention — deliberately direct attention\*\***
4. **\*\*pay respect/tribute/etc. — express or give something abstract\*\***
5. **\*\*pay a price/penalty — suffer or bear a consequence\*\***
6. **\*\*noun — salary/wages/remuneration\*\***

I would merge **\*\*pay employees / pay a bill / pay for a product\*\*** under #1, merge **\*\*it pays to...\*\*** under #2, and treat **\*\*pay a visit\*\*** as an important fixed collocation rather than create an unnecessary seventh core sense.